

KALE

Brassica oleracea Acephala Group

Kale is a hardy and adaptable plant, able to survive subzero winter temperatures and, in the case of some varieties, hot summers as well. Packed with high levels of vitamins and minerals, it is delicious eaten raw in salads when young and tender, or boiled or stir-fried when leaves are mature. Kale is also an ideal ornamental plant, since its leaves are striking in shape and color and look good throughout the winter.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
SOW/PLANT				
HARVEST				

SOWING

Kale plants can become relatively large, up to 3 ft (90 cm) high and 2 ft (60 cm) wide, so they need both space to spread and firm soil to support their eventual weight. Sow seeds in early spring to produce a crop in summer, and sow in late spring to early summer to produce a crop in the fall or winter.

Sow in pots or module trays at a depth of .75 in (2 cm). Plants will be ready to transplant when they are about seven weeks old; be careful not to damage the roots when planting out. Kale can be grown as a cut-and-come-again crop and planted densely, with seedlings spaced at a distance of 3–4 in (8–10 cm). If you plan to let crops grow to full



Harvest whole kale plants when mature.

size, they will need to be planted about 18–24 in (45–60 cm) apart.

CROP CARE

Keep seedlings well-weeded and give them plenty of water while young. However, when plants are established, resist overwatering, since this produces lush growth that is less capable of overwintering. If the crop yellows in fall, remove affected